

APPLIED SKILL ENTRA

Lab: Get started with identities and access using Microsoft Entra

Lab scenario

You are an identity administrator for Contoso. The organization uses Microsoft Entra ID to manage cloud identities, groups, administrative roles, authentication settings, and Conditional Access policies.

In this lab, you will complete common identity and access administration tasks in Microsoft Entra ID. These tasks are aligned with the Microsoft Applied Skills assessment **Get started with identities and access using Microsoft Entra**, which validates beginner-level skills for managing identities and access in Microsoft Entra.

The assessment environment provides task instructions through email messages inside the lab Cloud PC. According to the referenced walkthrough, the lab includes several messages, including tasks for managing users, managing groups, documenting security configuration, and evaluating Conditional Access policies.

Objectives

After completing this lab, you will be able to:

- Sign in to the Microsoft Entra admin center.
 - Configure Microsoft Authenticator for the lab administrator account.
 - Create a new Microsoft Entra user.
 - Assign a Microsoft 365 license to a user.
 - Assign a Microsoft Entra administrative role to a user.
 - Invite an external guest user.
 - Create a security group.
 - Assign a Microsoft Entra role to a group.
 - Add members and owners to groups.
 - Review Password Protection settings.
 - Review Self-Service Password Reset authentication method settings.
 - Review Conditional Access named locations.
 - Use the Conditional Access **What If** tool.
 - Document configuration values in the Contoso Data Explorer or Contoso Data Editor application.
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Estimated time

60–90 minutes.

Prerequisites

To complete this lab, you need:

- Access to the Microsoft Applied Skills assessment lab environment.
- The Cloud PC credentials provided by the assessment environment.
- The Microsoft Entra administrator credentials provided in the lab email.
- A mobile phone with Microsoft Authenticator installed.
- Access to the following portals:
 - Microsoft Entra admin center: <https://entra.microsoft.com>
 - Microsoft 365 admin center: <https://admin.microsoft.com>

Microsoft documentation states that user creation and guest invitation tasks are performed from **Entra ID > Users**, and that license assignment can be performed from **Users > Active users** in the Microsoft 365 admin center.

Exercise 1: Prepare the lab environment

Task 1: Review the lab emails

1. Sign in to the assessment Cloud PC by using the credentials provided by Microsoft.
2. Open Outlook or the mail application in the lab environment.
3. Review all task emails.
4. Identify the emails related to:
 - Existing environment
 - Manage users or manage access
 - Manage groups
 - Document security configurations
 - Evaluate Conditional Access policies
 - Status or completion message

Important: Do not assume that the names, users, groups, roles, or settings are always the same. Always follow the values in the email messages inside your active assessment.

Task 2: Sign in to the Microsoft Entra admin center

1. Open Microsoft Edge.
 2. Go to <https://entra.microsoft.com>.
 3. Sign in by using the Microsoft Entra administrative account provided in the **Existing Environment** email.
 4. When prompted, complete Microsoft Authenticator registration.
 5. On your mobile phone, open Microsoft Authenticator.
 6. Scan the QR code shown in the browser.
 7. Approve the verification request.
 8. Confirm that the Authenticator setup is completed successfully.
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Task 3: Verify your administrative role

1. In the Microsoft Entra admin center, browse to **Entra ID**.
2. Select **Users**.
3. Search for the administrator account provided in the lab.
4. Open the user account.
5. Select **Assigned roles**.
6. Confirm that the account has the administrative permissions required for the lab.

Microsoft Entra roles are used to delegate permissions such as managing users, licenses, domains, and other Microsoft Entra resources.

Exercise 2: Manage users

Task 1: Create a new user

In this task, you create a new internal Microsoft Entra user based on the details provided in the lab email.

1. In the Microsoft Entra admin center, browse to **Entra ID**.
2. Select **Users**.
3. Select **New user**.
4. Select **Create new user**.
5. On the **Basics** tab, enter the user details from the email.

Example only:

Field	Example value
User principal name	bensmith@<tenant>.onmicrosoft.com
Display name	Ben Smith
First name	Ben
Last name	Smith
Account enabled	Yes

6. Select **Next: Properties**.

7. Complete all required user properties from the email, such as:

- Job title
- Department
- Company name
- Office location
- Usage location

8. Select **Next: Assignments**.

9. Do not assign groups or roles unless the email specifically instructs you to do so.

10. Select **Review + create**.

11. Review the configuration.

12. Select **Create**.

Validation

1. Browse to **Entra ID > Users**.
2. Search for the new user.
3. Confirm that the user exists.
4. Open the user account.
5. Confirm that the properties match the lab email.

Task 2: Assign a Microsoft 365 license to the new user

1. Open a new browser tab.
2. Go to <https://admin.microsoft.com>.
3. In the Microsoft 365 admin center, browse to **Users > Active users**.
4. Search for the user you created.
5. Select the user.
6. In the user details pane, select **Licenses and apps**.
7. Under **Licenses**, select the license specified in the email.

Example only:

- Office 365 E5

8. Select **Save changes**.

Microsoft documentation confirms that user licenses can be assigned from **Users > Active users > Licenses and Apps** in the Microsoft 365 admin center.

Validation

1. Return to the Microsoft Entra admin center.
 2. Browse to **Entra ID > Users**.
 3. Open the user.
 4. Select **Licenses**.
 5. Confirm that the required license is assigned.
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Task 3: Assign an administrative role to an existing user

In this task, you assign a Microsoft Entra built-in role to a user specified in the email.

1. In the Microsoft Entra admin center, browse to **Entra ID > Users**.
2. Search for the user specified in the email.

Example only:

- Lynne Robbins

3. Open the user account.
4. Select **Assigned roles**.
5. Select **Add assignments**.
6. Search for the role specified in the email.

Example only:

- Billing Administrator

7. Select the role.
8. Select **Add** or **Assign**.

Microsoft documentation confirms that Microsoft Entra roles can be assigned to users and groups from the Microsoft Entra admin center.

Validation

1. Stay on the user account page.
 2. Select **Assigned roles**.
 3. Confirm that the required role appears in the list.
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Task 4: Invite an external guest user

1. In the Microsoft Entra admin center, browse to **Entra ID > Users**.
2. Select **New user**.
3. Select **Invite external user**.
4. Enter the guest user details from the lab email.

Example fields:

Field	Action
Email address	Enter the external email address from the lab email
Display name	Enter the guest display name
Message	Enter the invitation message if required
Send invite message	Enable, unless instructed otherwise

5. Complete any additional fields requested in the email.
6. Select **Review + invite**.
7. Select **Invite**.

Microsoft documentation describes the guest invitation process from **Entra ID > Users > Invite external user**.

Validation

1. Browse to **Entra ID > Users**.
 2. Search for the guest user.
 3. Confirm the following:
 - The user exists.
 - **User type** is **Guest**.
 - **Creation type** is **Invitation**, if visible.
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Exercise 3: Manage groups

Task 1: Create a security group that can be assigned Microsoft Entra roles

In this task, you create a security group and make it eligible for Microsoft Entra role assignment.

1. In the Microsoft Entra admin center, browse to **Entra ID > Groups**.
2. Select **New group**.
3. Configure the group settings.

Example only:

Setting	Value
Group type	Security
Group name	Tech1
Group description	Security group for reports access
Microsoft Entra roles can be assigned to the group	Yes
Membership type	Assigned

4. Under **Members**, select **No members selected**.
5. Search for the user specified in the email.

Example only:

- Alex Wilber

6. Select the user.
7. Select **Select**.
8. Under **Roles**, add the role specified in the email.

Example only:

- Reports Reader

9. Select **Create**.

*Important: The option **Microsoft Entra roles can be assigned to the group** must be set to **Yes** during group creation. This setting cannot be changed after the group is created.*

Validation

1. Browse to **Entra ID > Groups**.
 2. Search for the group.
 3. Open the group.
 4. Confirm:
 - Group type is **Security**.
 - The correct member is listed.
 - The required Microsoft Entra role is assigned.
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Task 2: Add an owner to an existing group

1. In the Microsoft Entra admin center, browse to **Entra ID > Groups**.
2. Search for the group specified in the email.

Example only:

- SSPR
3. Open the group.
 4. Select **Owners**.
 5. Select **Add owners**.
 6. Search for the user specified in the email.

Example only:

- Alex Wilber
7. Select the user.
 8. Select **Select**.

Validation

1. Stay on the group page.
 2. Select **Owners**.
 3. Confirm that the required user is listed as an owner.
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Task 3: Add a member to an existing group

1. In the same group, select **Members**.
2. Select **Add members**.
3. Search for the user specified in the email.

Example only:

- Megan Bowen
4. Select the user.
 5. Select **Select**.

Validation

1. Select **Members**.
2. Confirm that the required user appears in the members list.

Exercise 4: Document security configurations

In this exercise, you review existing Microsoft Entra security settings and document the results in the Contoso Data Explorer or Contoso Data Editor application on the desktop.

The referenced walkthrough states that this part of the assessment includes reviewing Password Protection, password reset authentication methods, and named locations, then recording values in the Contoso desktop application.

Task 1: Review Password Protection settings

1. In the Microsoft Entra admin center, use the top search bar.
2. Search for **Password protection**.
3. Open the Password Protection settings page.
4. Review the configured settings.
5. Identify the value requested in the lab email.

Common values may include:

- Custom banned password list status
 - Number of custom banned password entries
 - Smart lockout settings
 - Lockout threshold
 - Lockout duration
6. Open the **Contoso Data Explorer** or **Contoso Data Editor** application from the desktop.
 7. Enter the required value in the matching field.
 8. Save the entry.

Microsoft Entra Password Protection blocks known weak passwords and variants. Microsoft also applies a global banned password list automatically to all users in a Microsoft Entra tenant.

Task 2: Review Self-Service Password Reset authentication methods

1. In the Microsoft Entra admin center, search for **Password reset**.
2. Open **Password reset**.
3. Select **Authentication methods**.
4. Review the value for **Number of methods required to reset**.
5. Review the enabled authentication methods.

Examples of methods may include:

- Mobile app notification
 - Mobile app code
 - Email
 - Mobile phone
 - Office phone
 - Security questions
6. If the email asks you to open a linked authentication method policy, select the relevant link.
 7. Record the requested values in the Contoso Data Explorer or Contoso Data Editor application.
 8. Save the entry.

Microsoft documentation explains that SSPR allows users to reset or unlock their account without help desk involvement, and administrators can configure authentication methods and registration settings.

Task 3: Review named locations

1. In the Microsoft Entra admin center, search for **Named locations**.
2. Open **Conditional Access > Named locations**.
3. Review all configured named locations.
4. Identify locations of type:
 - Countries location
 - IP ranges location
5. Open each relevant named location.
6. Record the requested values.

Example only:

Named location type	Example value
Countries location	Algeria
Countries location	Sweden
IP range location	Use the value shown in your lab

7. Enter the required values in the Contoso Data Explorer or Contoso Data Editor application.
8. Save the entry.

Microsoft documentation states that named locations can be country-based or IP-range-based and are used with Conditional Access policies.

Exercise 5: Evaluate Conditional Access policies

In this exercise, you use the Conditional Access **What If** tool to simulate a sign-in and determine which policies apply.

Microsoft documentation explains that the What If tool simulates a sign-in scenario for a user, app, and sign-in conditions, then reports which Conditional Access policies apply and which do not apply.

Task 1: Run a Conditional Access What If evaluation

1. In the Microsoft Entra admin center, search for **Conditional Access**.
2. Open **Conditional Access**.
3. Select **Policies**.
4. Select **What If**.
5. Configure the simulation using the values from the lab email.

Example only:

Setting	Example value
User	Diego Siciliani
Cloud app	Office 365 Exchange Online
Device platform	Android
Client app	Browser

Setting	Example value
Sign-in risk	High
IP address	131.107.1.10
Country/Region	United States

6. Select **What If**.
7. Wait for the evaluation results.

Task 2: Review the What If results

1. Review **Policies that will apply**.
2. Review **Policies that will not apply**.
3. Open each policy that the email asks you to inspect.
4. Review the **Users** or **Assignments** section.
5. Identify the selected users, groups, included users, or excluded users required by the lab email.
6. Record the required values in the Contoso Data Explorer or Contoso Data Editor application.
7. Save the entry.

Validation

Confirm that:

- The What If simulation was run with the exact conditions from the email.
- The required policies were reviewed.
- The requested policy user assignment values were documented.
- The Contoso Data Explorer or Contoso Data Editor entries were saved.

Exercise 6: Confirm completion

1. Return to the email application.
 2. Open the final status or completion email, if available.
 3. Review whether any additional action is required.
 4. Confirm that all Contoso Data Explorer or Contoso Data Editor values were saved.
 5. Confirm that all user, group, role, license, guest, and Conditional Access tasks were completed.
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Optional practice tasks

The referenced walkthrough notes that Microsoft may present similar scenarios in the assessment, including bulk user import, Microsoft 365 group creation, SSPR configuration for a group, per-user MFA review, and MFA service settings review.

Use the following tasks for additional preparation.

Optional Task 1: Bulk import users

1. In the Microsoft Entra admin center, browse to **Entra ID > Users**.
 2. Select **Bulk operations**.
 3. Select **Bulk create**.
 4. Download the CSV template.
 5. Fill in the required user details.
 6. Upload the completed CSV file.
 7. Validate the file.
 8. Submit the bulk create operation.
 9. Confirm that the users were created.
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Optional Task 2: Create a Microsoft 365 group

1. Browse to **Entra ID > Groups**.
 2. Select **New group**.
 3. For **Group type**, select **Microsoft 365**.
 4. Enter the group name and description.
 5. Add owners, if required.
 6. Add members, if required.
 7. Select **Create**.
 8. Confirm that the group exists.
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Optional Task 3: Enable SSPR for a selected group

1. Browse to **Entra ID > Password reset**.
2. Select **Properties**.
3. Under **Self service password reset enabled**, select **Selected**.
4. Select the group that should be enabled for SSPR.
5. Select **Save**.
6. Select **Authentication methods**.
7. Configure the number of methods required to reset.

8. Enable the required methods.
9. Select **Save**.

Microsoft documentation confirms that SSPR can be enabled for **None**, **Selected**, or **All** users, and that the selected-group option is commonly used for staged deployment.

Optional Task 4: Review per-user MFA settings

1. Open the Microsoft 365 admin center.
 2. Browse to **Users > Active users**.
 3. Select **Multi-factor authentication**.
 4. Review the MFA state for the required user.
 5. Confirm whether the user is:
 - Disabled
 - Enabled
 - Enforced
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Optional Task 5: Review MFA service settings

1. Open the per-user MFA page from the Microsoft 365 admin center.
 2. Select **Service settings**.
 3. Review the available configuration options, such as:
 - App passwords
 - Trusted IPs
 - Verification options
 - Remember MFA settings
 4. Record only the settings requested by the lab instructions.
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Final validation checklist

Before submitting or ending the assessment, confirm the following:

Area	Validation
Admin access	You can access the Microsoft Entra admin center
MFA	Microsoft Authenticator setup is complete
User creation	The required user was created
User properties	User properties match the email instructions

Area	Validation
Licensing	The required license was assigned
Role assignment	The required Microsoft Entra role was assigned
Guest access	The external guest user was invited
Security group	The required security group was created
Group role	The required role was assigned to the group
Group owner	The required owner was added
Group member	The required member was added
Password Protection	Required settings were documented
SSPR methods	Required authentication method settings were documented
Named locations	Required named location values were documented
Conditional Access	What If simulation was completed
Policy documentation	Required policy assignment details were saved
Contoso app	All required values were saved

Troubleshooting

You cannot sign in to the Entra admin center

- Confirm that you are using the administrator account from the lab email.
- Confirm that you completed Microsoft Authenticator setup.
- Try signing in again using an InPrivate browser window.

The license is not available

- Confirm that you are in the Microsoft 365 admin center.
- Confirm that the user has a valid usage location.
- Refresh the user page and check again.
- Use the license specified in the email, not a similar license.

The role assignment option is missing

- Confirm that you have sufficient administrative permissions.

- Confirm that you selected the correct user or group.
- For groups, confirm that **Microsoft Entra roles can be assigned to the group** was enabled during group creation.

The guest invitation fails

- Confirm that the email address is valid.
- Confirm that external collaboration is allowed in the tenant.
- Confirm that you selected **Invite external user**, not **Create new user**.

The Conditional Access What If result looks different

- Confirm that every simulation field exactly matches the email:
 - User
 - Cloud app
 - Device platform
 - Client app
 - Sign-in risk
 - IP address
 - Country or region
- Run the simulation again.
- Review both policies that apply and policies that do not apply.

Notes for the assessment

- Read every email carefully before making changes.
- Do not skip the documentation tasks in the Contoso desktop application.
- Use the exact values from the lab environment.
- Save after every entry in the Contoso Data Explorer or Contoso Data Editor application.
- Do not delete or clean up objects unless the assessment explicitly instructs you to do so.
- If a portal page does not refresh immediately, wait a few seconds and refresh the page.
- When in doubt, return to the email instructions and verify the exact expected value.